

1840. Louis Agassiz shows that an ice sheet once covered Switzerland, and suggests that an Ice Age occurred in recent geological history.

1869. The father of biogeography Alfred Russel Wallace reports a clear evolutionary division in fauna species on neighbouring islands.

1896. Svante Arrhenius is the first to argue that carbon dioxide emissions can lead to global warming.

1912. Alfred Wegener presents his theory that Earth was once a single landmass from which continents drifted apart.

1926. Vladimir Vernadsky’s book The Biosphere explains how atmospheric gases are created by biological processes.